

A1 Level: Simple Present Tense Study & Practice Material

Grammar Rules, Suffix Transformation Tables & Student Exercises

Student Name: Date:
Score: / 25

TABLE 1: SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE GRAMMAR RULES

Sentence Form	Structural Pattern	Example Sentences
Affirmative (+)	Subject + Base Verb (V1)	• I wake up at 7:00 AM every morning. • They live in London.
	I / You / We / They	
Affirmative (+)	Subject + Base Verb + -s/-es/-ies	• She drinks tea every afternoon. • He watches TV in the evening.
	He / She / It	
Negative (-)	Subject + do not (don't) + Base Verb	• We don't play football on Mondays. • You don't eat meat.
	I / You / We / They	
Negative (-)	Subject + does not (doesn't) + Base Verb	• He doesn't work on Sundays. • She doesn't like cold weather.
	He / She / It	

Question (?)	Do/Does + Subject + Base Verb?	• Do you speak English? – Yes, I do. • Does he live here? – No, he doesn't.
	All Subjects	

KEY GRAMMAR RULE: In negative sentences and questions with does/doesn't, the main verb stays in base form (V1). Never add -s after does or doesn't!

Correct: He doesn't like coffee. **Incorrect:** He doesn't likes coffee.

TABLE 2: THIRD-PERSON SINGULAR SUFFIX CHANGES (-S / -ES / -IES)

Suffix	Spelling Rules & Verb Endings	Pronunciation Rules & Examples
-s	Add -s to most standard base verbs. work → works, eat → eats, play → plays	• /s/ sound after voiceless sounds (/p, t, k, f/): likes, works, sleeps, hits • /z/ sound after voiced sounds (/b, d, g, v, m, n, vowels/): plays, lives, reads, runs
-es	Add -es to verbs ending in sibilants: -ch, -sh, -x, -ss, -z, or -o. watch → watches, wash → washes, go → goes	• /ɪz/ sound adds an extra syllable: watch-es (2 syllables), finish-es (3 syllables)
-ies	Verbs ending in Consonant + Y: Drop 'y' and add -ies. study → studies, carry → carries, fly → flies *(If ending in Vowel + Y, just add -s: play → plays).	• Pronounced as /z/: stud-ies / 'stʌd.i:z/, car-ries / 'kær.i:z/

STUDENT PRACTICE PART 1: CONTROLLED GRAMMAR EXERCISES

TASK 1: SUFFIX TRANSFORMATION & SPELLING CHECK (6 Points)

Write the correct 3rd-person singular form (he / she / it) for each verb.

wake	→
study	→
watch	→
play	→
finish	→
fix	→

TASK 2: SENTENCE FORM TRANSFORMATION (6 Points)

(+) Sarah drinks green tea every morning.

(-) Sarah green tea every morning.

(+) They live near the city center.

(?) near the city center?

(+) My father works at a university.

(-) My father at a university.

TASK 3: DAILY ROUTINE CONTEXTUAL FILL-IN-THE-BLANKS (5 Points)

Word bank: live | eat | not drink | teach | carry

Alex is an English instructor. He (1) in Ankara. Every morning, he (2) breakfast at 8:00 AM. He (3) coffee, so he chooses tea instead. In the afternoon, he (4) English at an academy. He always (5) his laptop in a black bag.

TASK 4: PHONETIC SUFFIX SOUND CATEGORIZATION (4 Points)

1. works	→ /s/ /z/ /ɪz/
2. teaches	→ /s/ /z/ /ɪz/
3. lives	→ /s/ /z/ /ɪz/
4. dances	→ /s/ /z/ /ɪz/

STUDENT PRACTICE PART 2: INTERACTIVE PAIR SPEAKING ACTIVITY

TASK 5: FIND OUT ABOUT YOUR PARTNER (4 Points)

Ask your partner 2 questions about their weekly habits. Write complete sentences reporting their answers.

Example: "Do you play guitar on weekends?" → "He plays guitar on weekends."
(-s suffix)

Questions I asked:

1.

.....

2.

.....

Partner's answers (reported):

1.

.....

2.

.....